

Parameter-map doc — revisions per Haochen's feedback

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This companion note summarises the changes made to `dnaa5_oric_saturation_parameter_space.md` in response to Haochen's three comments on the first version, and flags what is still open.

Haochen's comment 1 — scan shape parameters within a chosen form

Part 3. Cooperativity functional form at `oriC`: when exploring different function forms, also explore parameters of those forms. For example, for Hill function, not only explore Hill coefficient n (how sharp the transition is), but also scan different K (where the transition happens).

Change made: §3 now ends with an explicit note that within a chosen form, the shape parameters must be scanned too — for Hill specifically, scan **both** the Hill coefficient n (sharpness) **and** K (midpoint).

Haochen's comment 2 — hydrolysis at `oriC` should not be the cluster-reset mechanism

Part 5. DnaA-ATP hydrolysis at `oriC` (cluster reset): I'm confused by this part, because cluster reset should always happen right after initiation because all bound DnaA at `oriC` should fall back to the cytoplasm at that moment. Because the time window of `oriC` saturation is typically much shorter than DnaA-ATP half-life, the hydrolysis of DnaA-ATP bound at `oriC` should be negligible and should not be the main reason for the cluster reset. Please double-check if this is true in the current implementation.

Code check: the comment in `dnaa_box_binding.py` explicitly says *“fork release is what actually destroys the state.”* So fork release at initiation IS the dominant reset mechanism in the current implementation. Hydrolysis at `oriC` runs in the background at $k_h = 0.025/\text{min}$ (uniform across all DnaA-ATP pools, bound and free), but it is not what cleans out the cluster after initiation.

Change made: §5 (the hydrolysis / cluster-reset section) has been removed entirely. It was framing hydrolysis as a tuning lever for cluster reset, which is incorrect. Sections downstream have been renumbered; the hydrolysis entry has also been dropped from the ranked-knobs list.

Haochen’s comment 3 — try real initiation triggering by `oriC` saturation

One thing I realize is that maybe we should do real initiation triggering at this stage — not artificially by mass, but by `oriC` saturation events. My concern is that initiation itself is a feedback to `oriC` state — if `oriC` saturation is too fast, initiation happens early, which will generate more DnaA boxes during replications and titrate redundant DnaA-ATP; if `oriC` saturation is too slow, initiation will not happen, allowing DnaA-ATP to keep accumulating, until `oriC` saturates. Without this feedback, you might always see over- or under-saturation at `oriC`, as you and Eran recently obtained, but it can be an artifact by mass-triggering initiations. The caveat is that this could mess up the regular cell cycles (being very long or short) and affect other processes in the background. I would still give it a try and see what would happen.

Status: open. Not yet incorporated as a documented parameter-space axis.

Next step proposed: replace the mass-clock gate in `chromosome_replication.py` (currently `criticalMassPerOriC ≥ 1.0`) with an `oriC`-saturation gate (init fires when at least one chromosome’s `oriC_low` cluster is fully bound). This is a code change rather than a parameter sweep; to be tried as a focused experiment with the current best lineage config ($V=1.5$ + Hill K_d) to see whether the feedback Haochen describes does in fact clamp the late-gen drift.